UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS

PLACEMENT SERVICE: Graduate Office
gradofc-econ@berkeley.edu

Alessandro Marchetti-Bowick
amarchettibowick@berkeley.edu
https://amarchettibowick.github.io/

BUSINESS ADDRESS:
Department of Economics
530 Evans Hall, #3880
Berkeley, CA 94720-3880

RESEARCH AND TEACHING FIELDS:

PRIMARY
Public Economics
Labor Economics

SECONDARY
Economics of Inequality

EDUCATION | **DEGREE** | **DATE**

UC Berkeley | Ph.D. in Economics | 2027 (expected)
Thesis: Causes and Consequences of Restricting the Safety Net
Committee: Hilary Hoynes, Danny Yagan, Patrick Kline

Stanford University | B.A. in Economics | 2017

WORKING PAPERS:

- 30 Years of Welfare-to-Work: Intergenerational Impacts of Welfare Reform (Job Market Paper)

  Nearly 30 years ago, President Bill Clinton signed the Personal Responsibility and Work Opportunity Reconciliation Act (PRWORA), abolishing federal entitlement to cash assistance. Using confidential Census Bureau data, we document the long-run impacts of PRWORA on individuals who were children at the time of reform. Our research design compares siblings born to the same mother who were different ages at the time of reform and contrasts these within-family differences between families more and less likely to have received welfare. We find that exposure to welfare reform decreased childhood welfare receipt and increased parental employment. While on average these counteracting effects left net family income unchanged, the average conceals considerable variation, with Black families facing decreases in net income and white families facing increases. In adulthood, exposure to welfare reform increased both earnings and employment. Earnings effects follow a life-cycle profile, appearing as early as age 18 and fading entirely by age 24, while employment gains persist through at least age 30 and come from lower-paying, less stable jobs. We also find that welfare reform reduced teen births, teen arrests, and receipt of housing assistance, but had no discernible impact on mortality and participation in the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program or Medicaid. Effects are more pronounced for girls than boys and proportional to parents' time spent working, which suggests that our results are driven by children emulating their parents.

- The Take-Up Gap: Sorting versus Place Effects in Medicaid with Carl McPherson (in preparation)

  Take-up of safety net benefits varies widely across places, but it is unclear whether this reflects the effect of place itself or the sorting of different types of people into different places. We study this question for Medicaid among low-income, childless adults in states that expanded eligibility under the Affordable Care Act, where eligibility rules are fixed across place. Using internal Census Bureau data, we estimate a two-way fixed effects model to decompose person and county effects in Medicaid take-up. We then follow individuals who move across counties in an event-study design, asking whether their take-up shifts toward the level of their destination effect, which would indicate a causal effect of place. We relate the estimated county effects to state policies and local characteristics, including administrative burden, information, and stigma, to understand what drives low take-up.

WORK IN PROGRESS:

- Sharing a Home, Sharing the Cost: Impacts of the Informal Safety Net with Raheem Chaudhry, Alison Lodermeier, and Grace Ortuzar

  Low-income families rely not only on support from the formal safety net but also on informal support from family and friends. Unlike publicly provided aid, the informal safety net generates private costs for the individuals providing assistance. We study these costs in the context of a particularly prevalent form of informal support: doubling up, in which multiple families share a single residence. Using linked Census Bureau data, we estimate the prevalence of doubling up and its impact on the social and economic well-being of host families. Our empirical strategy exploits quasi-random variation in a household's likelihood of hosting, combining variation in the timing of a relative's receipt of federal rental assistance and distance to that relative. The project will produce national estimates of the prevalence of doubling-up and causal evidence on the effects of co-residence for host families.

- Why Is Welfare Hard to Get? Using AFDC to Estimate Revealed Welfare Weights

Why do governments make welfare hard to obtain? Standard models attribute eligibility rules and administrative burden to fiscal constraints and optimal targeting of aid, but governments may also hold preferences over which families deserve aid. This paper tests for such preferences by estimating states' revealed welfare weights. Identification comes from how states adjusted policy instruments (acceptance rates, case closures, and payment levels) after federal actions in the 1960s required them to readmit Black families to welfare. Historical changes to the federal matching formulas, which altered states' costs without changing caseload composition, provide a race-neutral benchmark for budget effects.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

RESEARCH:

Research Assistant, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley (2021-22)
Created, ran, and analyzed a survey of expert opinions on the presence and degree of discrimination among U.S. employers with Pat Kline and Chris Walters.

Research Assistant, Princeton Program in Public Finance, Princeton University (2018-2020)
Performed empirical work on projects studying the impact of the Earned Income Tax Credit on the extensive margin labor supply of single mothers and the effect of union density on aggregate inequality with Henrik Kleven and Ilyana Kuziemko.

TEACHING:

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley (Fall 2021- Spring 2025)
Labor Economics, Econometrics, and Economics for Public Policy

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS:

2025	Institute for Research on Labor and Employment Dissertation Fellowship
2025	Stone Center Continuing Student Fellowship
2024	Burch Center Continuing Student Fellowship
2024	Family Policy to Reduce Racial Inequalities in Health Hub Grant
2017	Anna Laura Myers Prize for an Outstanding Thesis

OTHER INFORMATION:

Languages:	English, Italian (intermediate)
Citizenship:	United States, Italy
Clearances:	U.S. Census Bureau Special Sworn Status

REFERENCES:

Professor Hilary Hoynes
Department of Economics
UC Berkeley
hoynes@berkeley.edu

Professor Danny Yagan
Department of Economics
UC Berkeley
yagan@berkeley.edu

Professor Patrick Kline
Department of Economics
UC Berkeley
pkline@berkeley.edu